

Situational Approach Description

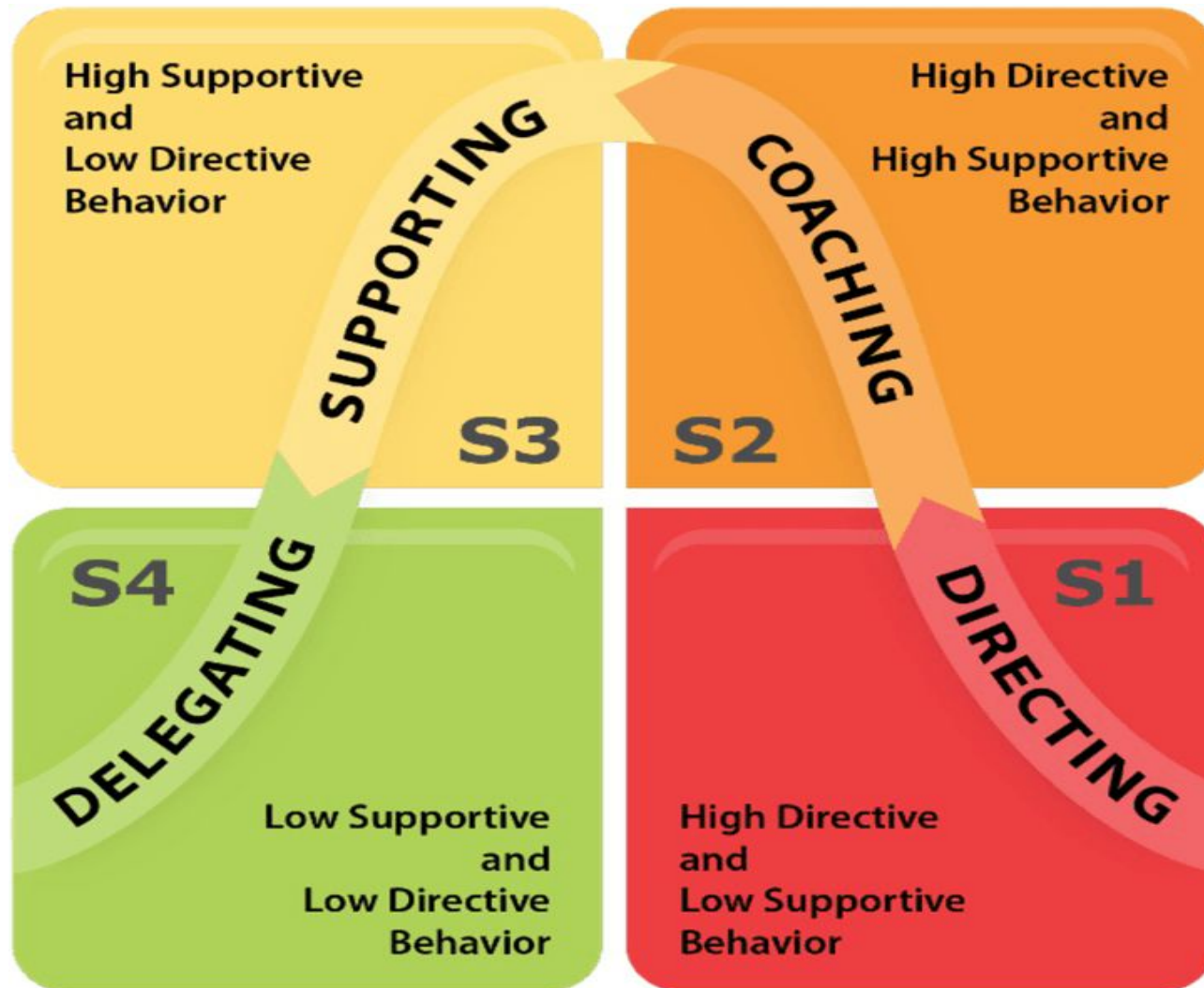
(Hersey & Blanchard, 1969)

“Leaders match their style to the competence and commitment of subordinates”

Perspective

- Focuses on leadership in **situations**
- Emphasizes **adapting style** - different situations demand different kinds of leadership
- **Used extensively** in organizational leadership training and development

Example



Situational Approach Description, cont'd

(Hersey & Blanchard, 1969)

Definition

- Composed of both a **directive dimension** & **supportive dimension**:
 - Each dimension must be **applied appropriately** in a given situation
 - Leaders **evaluate employees** to assess their **competence and commitment** to perform a given task

Leadership Styles

Definition

- Leadership style - **the behavior pattern** of an individual who attempts to influence others

It includes both:

- Directive (**task**) behaviors
- Supportive (**relationship**) behaviors

Leadership Styles

Dimension Definition

- ***Directive behaviors*** - Help group members in **goal achievement** via ***one-way communication*** through:
 - Giving directions
 - Establishing goals & how to achieve them
 - Methods of evaluation & time lines
 - Defining roles

Leadership Styles

Dimension Definitions

- *Supportive behaviors* - **Assist group members via *two-way communication* in feeling comfortable with themselves, co-workers, and situation**
 - Asking for input
 - Problem solving
 - Praising, listening

S1 - Directing Style

- Leader focuses communication on goal achievement
- Spends LESS time using supportive behaviors

S2 - Coaching Style

- Leader focuses communication on BOTH goal achievement and supporting subordinates' socioemotional needs
- Requires leader involvement through encouragement and soliciting subordinate input

S3 - Supporting Style

- Leader does NOT focus solely on goals; uses supportive behaviors to bring out employee skills in accomplishing tasks
- Leader delegates day-to-day decision-making control but is available to facilitate problem solving

S4 - Delegating Style

- Leader offers LESS task input and social support; facilitates subordinates' confidence and motivation in relation to the task
- Leader lessens involvement in planning, control of details, and goal clarification
- Gives subordinates control and refrains from intervention and unneeded social support

How Does The Situational Approach Work?

Using SLII[®] model – In any given situation the leader has two tasks:

1st Task

Diagnose the Situation

Identify the developmental level of employee

Ask questions like:

- What is the task subordinates are being asked to perform?
- How complicated is it?
- What is their skill set?
- Do they have the desire to complete the job?

2nd Task

Adapt Style

- Leadership style **must correspond** to the employee's development level

How Does the Situational Approach Work?

Employee's Developmental Level

- Competence
- Commitment

Leader's Leadership Style

- Directive
- Supportive

Class task – 15 minutes

- This is an individual task
- Choose one style – S1, S2, S3 or S4
- Justify the reasons for choosing it
- Present your opinion – 2 minutes each